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UAE pledges \$550m in aid to UN

ABU DHABI

Under the directives of President His Highness Sheikh Mohamed Bin Zayed Al Nahyan, the UAE has announced a pledge of \$550 million to support the UN's Global Humanitarian Overview (GHO), which aims to raise \$33 billion in 2026 to support approximately 135 million people across 23 humanitarian operations worldwide, including programmes supporting refugees and migrants.

The immediate focus of the appeal is to help protect the lives of up to 87 million people in need of urgent support with \$23 billion in funding.

The initiative reaffirms UAE's commitment to advancing international efforts to save lives and respond to disasters and crises affecting the most vulnerable. — WAM

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RTA's smart command centre drives Dubai's mobility vision

EC³ EASES TRAFFIC, INTEGRATES ALL MODES OF TRANSPORT

DUBAI

BY ASHFAQ AHMED
Managing Editor

Dubai's Roads and Transport Authority (RTA) is advancing its strategic vision for seamless and sustainable mobility, placing the Enterprise Command and Control Centre (EC³) at the heart of traffic management and transport coordination across the emirate.

The EC³, one of the world's largest and most advanced transport command facilities, integrates all current and future modes of transport. It monitors more than 28,000 vehicles, manages 10,000 cameras, and analyses 4.4 billion daily mobility data entries. Linking over 34 technological systems in real time and utilising artificial intelligence and machine learning, the centre enables rapid incident response, optimises traffic flow, and minimises human error.

Sheikh Mohammed Bin Rashid Bin Mohammed Bin Rashid Al Maktoum visited the EC³ to review RTA's strategic plan and upcoming mobility initiatives. He was received by Mattar Al Tayar, Director Gen-

28,000
vehicles monitored
daily by the transport
command centre

10,000
cameras managed
daily by the
advanced EC³

eral and Chairman of the Board of Executive Directors of RTA, who briefed Sheikh Mohammed Bin Rashid on how the centre supports coordinated decision-making, improves bus and taxi operations, and ensures smooth mobility during major events and emergencies.

RTA's strategic plan includes expanding and upgrading Dubai's road and public transport networks to meet the emirate's growing demands. The road network now spans over 25,000 lane-kilometres, featuring more

than 1,000 vehicle bridges and tunnels and 177 pedestrian bridges and tunnels. The public transport system comprises a 100-kilometre metro and tram network with 64 stations, 1,380 buses, 13,900 taxis and limousines, and 210 marine transport modes, serving more than two million riders daily.

Key RTA projects

Key projects include the Dubai Metro Blue Line, a 30-kilometre extension connecting the Red and Green lines, providing a direct 20-minute link to Dubai International Airport and serving areas projected to house one million residents by 2040.

RTA is also advancing aerial taxis and autonomous vehicle projects. In collaboration with Joby Aviation Inc. and Skyports Infrastructure, aerial taxis completed successful crewed test flights, with passenger services planned for 2026. Autonomous taxi trials are underway, with commercial operations expected in Q1 2026.

Through the EC³ and these initiatives, RTA is strengthening Dubai's position as a global leader in smart, integrated, and sustainable urban mobility.

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